

Data Mining

Numbers and figures form the basis of commerce. Online analytical processing (or OLAP) were used to keep tabs on an entity or a company and to predict the path they may take in the near future. This can be done using easily available data. OLAP tools can be used by people to analyse multi-dimensional data interactively from multiple perspectives. Assuming you ask the right questions.

The next level of OLAP is the process of Data Mining. The beauty of this method is that you can get the same level of information without having to directly ask specific questions. Data mining serves two primary roles with respect to information: The predictive role and the preemptive role.

The predictive role uses your own hidden knowledge and cross examines them with probabilities and the likelihood of future trends. The preemptive



Data mining helps make sense of patterns from large data sets

role is when data miners use knowledge that you should probably have to do the same.

In short: Data mining does the hard work for you and figures out what questions to ask your OLAP tools for a more accurately useful answer.

It's an interesting skill and very hard to master. If you like a challenge, the rigours of data mining is completely up your alley.

Practice manoeuvring your way in the Stock Market

Having a good idea of the stock market is pretty critical to someone dabbling in the commerce stream. That's serious stuff. Not to mention addictive,